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MAY 26, 1943

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD–C–491
June 28, 1932

FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOG

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

CLOTHS; WIPING

This specification was approved on the above date by the Director of Procurement, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government, and shall become effective not later than August 1, 1943. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATION.

A–1. The following Federal Specification, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall form a part of this specification:

CCC–T–191. Textiles; general specifications, test methods.

B. TYPES.

B–1. The cloths shall be of the following two types as specified in the invitation for bids:

Type I—White.
Type II—Mixed light-colored.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP.

C–1. *Material.*—

C–1a. Cloths for wiping purposes shall be of new, clean, soft, and absorbent fabrics, predominantly cotton, except as provided otherwise herein. Rayon, silk, and mixtures of rayon, silk, and cotton, either knitted or woven, if absorbent, will be accepted.

C–1b. Curtain or other open-mesh and knit materials will not be accepted, if the mesh is larger than 5/32-inch square.

C–1c. Toweling, heavy-napped fabrics, and starched or stiffened cloths will not be accepted.

C–1d. Cloths which have been dyed to obliterate stains and other defects will not be accepted.

C–2. *Workmanship.*—

C–2a. Cloths shall be free from grit and dirt and as free as practicable from seams.

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D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D–1. See section E.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

E–1. *Weight.*—Cloths shall weigh not more than 9 ounces or less than 2 ounces per square yard.

E–2. *Size.*—Each cloth shall have an area of at least 2 square feet and no cloth shall be longer than 30 inches or narrower than 10 inches.

E–3. *Absorbency.*—All cloths shall be absorbent, as defined in paragraph F–5, to oil and water when tested in accordance with the requirements of that paragraph.

E–4. *Invoice weights.*—

E–4a. Invoice weights governing payments shall be on the basis of net weight of deliveries, with a moisture regain of 7 plus or minus 1 percent. If invoiced weights are based on moisture regains of more or less than 7 plus or minus 1 percent, then payments shall be made on adjusted weights based on the standard commercial regain of 7 percent.

E–5. *Baling.*—

E–5a. Each bale shall contain cloths in the following proportions, unless other proportions are specified in the invitation for bids:

Cloths weighing from 2 to less than 6 ounces per square yard (minimum quantity per bale)	65 percent.
Curtain, knit rayon and mixed rayon and silk (maximum quantity per bale)	15 percent.
Cloths weighing 6 to 9 ounces per square yard	Remainder.

E–5b. The bales shall conform to the requirements of table I:

TABLE I.—*Net weight and volume of bale*

Net weight (pounds):	*Volume (cubic feet)*
45–55	2½–3½
90–110	5–7
540–660	25–35

E–5c. The tare—that is, the weight of baling materials (cotton baling fabric, bands, etc.)—should not exceed 6 percent of the gross weight and if it exceeds 10 percent, the waste shall be rejected.

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS.

F–1. *Sampling.*—See paragraphs F–2a, F–2b, and F–4.

F–2. *Inspection.*—Will be made at contractor's works and/or after delivery as may be selected by the Government, unless otherwise specified.

F–2a. *Preliminary.*—Inspection shall be conducted after wiping cloths have been baled as required by paragraph E–5. The inspector shall take at random not less than 3 bales from each lot of 260 or less. Each wiping cloth or each bale selected shall be carefully inspected for cleanliness, quality, size, trimming, and other requirements of this specification. Wiping cloths which are deficient in any respect will be considered unsatisfactory. If the average percentage of unsatisfactory material by weight is more than 5 percent, the entire lot of bales sub-

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mitted for inspection shall be rejected. In computing this percentage, only the weight of the wiping cloths will be considered.

F–2b. *Final.*—If the selected sample bales are found to be in accordance with the above requirements, the inspector may, if desired, divide the entire lot of bales presented for inspection into groups containing 10 bales each. One bale of each group will be opened and inspected in such a manner as may be necessary to assure the inspector that the material is of a quality equal to that found by the "piece by piece" inspection described in paragraph F–2a. If 10 percent or more of the bales thus inspected are of a quality inferior to that permitted by paragraph F–2a, the entire lot shall be rejected.

F–3. *Tare.*—Shall be determined on the bales opened for inspection as required by paragraph F–2b. The tare shall be the weight of the baling material (knitted baling and banding materials).

F–4. *Moisture regain.*—

F–4a. Three samples, each containing about 1 pound of cloths, shall be taken from each bale selected for inspection (pars. F–2a or H–2a) immediately after the bales are weighed. Two of the three samples shall be taken from opposite sides and the third from near the center of the bale.

F–4b. The samples selected shall be taken from the bales and accurately weighed within a time limit of approximately 45 seconds. If it is not practicable to weigh the samples at point of inspection, then they shall be placed immediately in airtight containers and forwarded to the laboratory at which test is to be made.

F–4c. The samples for test shall be dried in an oven at 221° to 230° F. (105° to 110° C.) until the weights of the cloths from two consecutive weighings, taken not less than 10 minutes apart, differ by not more than 0.1 percent of the first of the two weights.

F–4d. The moisture regain is the difference between the weight of the cloths as sampled (Wo) and their "dry weight" (Wd), paragraph F–4c, expressed as a percentage of the dry weight; that is,

$$\text{Moisture regain (percent)} = \frac{Wo - Wd}{Wd} \times 100$$

F–4e. The average of the moisture regains of the individual samples shall be considered the moisture regain of the entire lot represented by the samples.

F–5. *Absorption.*—A wiping cloth shall be laid flat on a wooden surface and several drops of water and several drops of oil applied. If the water and oil spread or fan out into the surrounding fabric within 30 seconds, the cloth shall be considered absorbent. If the water or oil is not absorbed, but rolls or otherwise spreads on top of the cloth, the cloth shall be considered nonabsorbent.

G. PACKING AND MARKING FOR SHIPMENT.

G–1. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be properly baled in knitted baling cloth, or other suitable material affording equal protection. When wiping cloths are used for baling, not over three pieces, properly overlapped, shall be used on the 50-pound bales and not over six, similarly arranged, on the heavier 100-pound bales. Bales shall be secured by not less than three trans-

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verse bands of steel strapping or wire on the 50-pound bale, and by not less than four transverse bands of steel strapping or five strands of wire on bales weighing in excess of approximately 50 pounds. Steel wire, if used, shall be not less than 0.062 inch in diameter and shall be suitably tied so as to afford protection from tearing of other bales and injury to personnel in handling.

G–2. *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, each bale shall be marked or stenciled (not tagged or labeled) with the name of the material and the quantity contained therein as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. The following departmental specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, shall form a part of this specification and shall be applicable to purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

H–2. *Army.*—U. S. Army Specifications No. 100–2, Standard Specifications for Marking Shipments.

H–2a. For Army purchases, shipments of wiping cloths shall not contain more than 25 percent of the cloth from 2 to 3 square feet in area, and not less than 25 percent from 5 to 6 square feet in area.

H–3. *Navy.*—Navy Department General Specifications for Inspection of Material, copies of which may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

H–3a. The Navy Department will make inspection as outlined in paragraphs F–2a and F–2b at place of manufacture and as outlined in paragraphs F–4 and H–3b at destination.

H–3b. Final inspection, unless otherwise specified, shall be made at destination within 7 days after delivery of a shipment. Three bales from each carload or shipment shall be selected. Each wiping cloth of each bale shall be carefully inspected for compliance with the requirements of this specification. If the average percentage of unsatisfactory material, by weight in all bales selected, is more than 7½ percent, the entire lot of bales represented shall be rejected. In computing this percentage, only the weight of the wiping cloths will be considered. In the event of rejection, it shall be the privilege of the contractor to reinspect the sampled bales either at the warehouse of the Navy Department or at the point of shipment. If returned to point of original shipment, all freight and transportation charges shall be paid by the contractor.

H–3c. *Moisture and tare.*—

H–3c (1). Payment will be made on the basis of gross weight when a tare of 6 percent for 50-pound and 100-pound bales, or 5 percent for 600-pound bales, or a moisture content of 7 percent is not exceeded.

H–3c (2). Requisitions, requests, schedules, and contracts or orders should provide for the following basis of payment in lieu of that described in paragraph E–4a:

"That when the tare is in excess of 6 percent for 50-pound and 100-pound bales, or 5 percent for 600-pound bales, or the moisture content is in excess of 7 percent and neither in excess of 10 percent,

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G. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING.

G–1. Any special requirements of the individual departments of the Government are noted in section H.

G–2. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the material shall be packed in substantial containers, so constructed as to insure acceptance by common or other carrier, for safe transportation, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery.

G–3. *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material, the size, the type, quantity contained therein, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. The following departmental specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall form a part of this specification:

H–1a. Army: United States Army Specification No. 100–2.

H–1b. Navy: Navy Department General Specification for Inspection of Material—Together with Appendix III—Textiles. Copies of this specification and appendix may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

I. NOTES.

I–1. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I–2. This specification governs all United States Government purchases of this commodity. Users are requested to retain this specification in permanent file until a revision is issued.

I–3. Interested parties are advised that an Alphabetical Index of Federal Specifications may be obtained upon application to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Price to be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

I–4. Copies of this specification and also CCC–T–191 may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents. Price 5 cents.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility or any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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